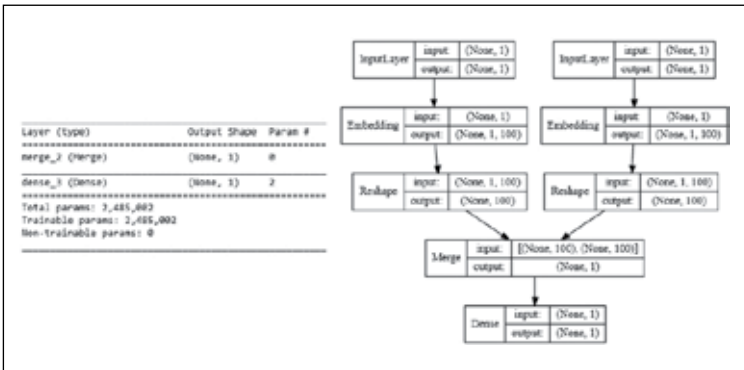


APIs are no longer just mediums for exchanging data. Taking a look at the APIs for websites like Twitter, Google Analytics or supply chain companies like UPS would show you how to get from point A to point B.

True to their name, functional APIs differ from the conventional sequential systems by giving away much needed functional outputs of the datasets and enjoy their popularity for cutting down on data silos in the industry.

As deep learning came to the rescue for emerging data centred companies, the onus was on developers to work with networks that promised faster results to those that promised better adaptability.



Typical Functional API

Take the example of the often overlooked navigation API used by Google Maps. Developers needed to create systems that worked on multiple geographic data, traffic networks and directions to create a mapping technology that could update every second based on changes and user input. Creating a complex network of datasets linked with primary keys and common tuples was never a simple task until functional APIs came into the picture. It's for this reason that they can help developers instil an element of usability to the API which would surely arise in the future.

WHAT MAKES A FUNCTIONAL API

Going with a simple textbook definition of terminologies, one might say that the average functional API can deliver a call when requested. Or in other words, any system that can return data when requested in a suitable format. But why do we need functional APIs in the first place?